



APPROACH PAPER FOR

HERITAGE GUIDELINES

FOR

TRIMBAK TOWN, NASIK

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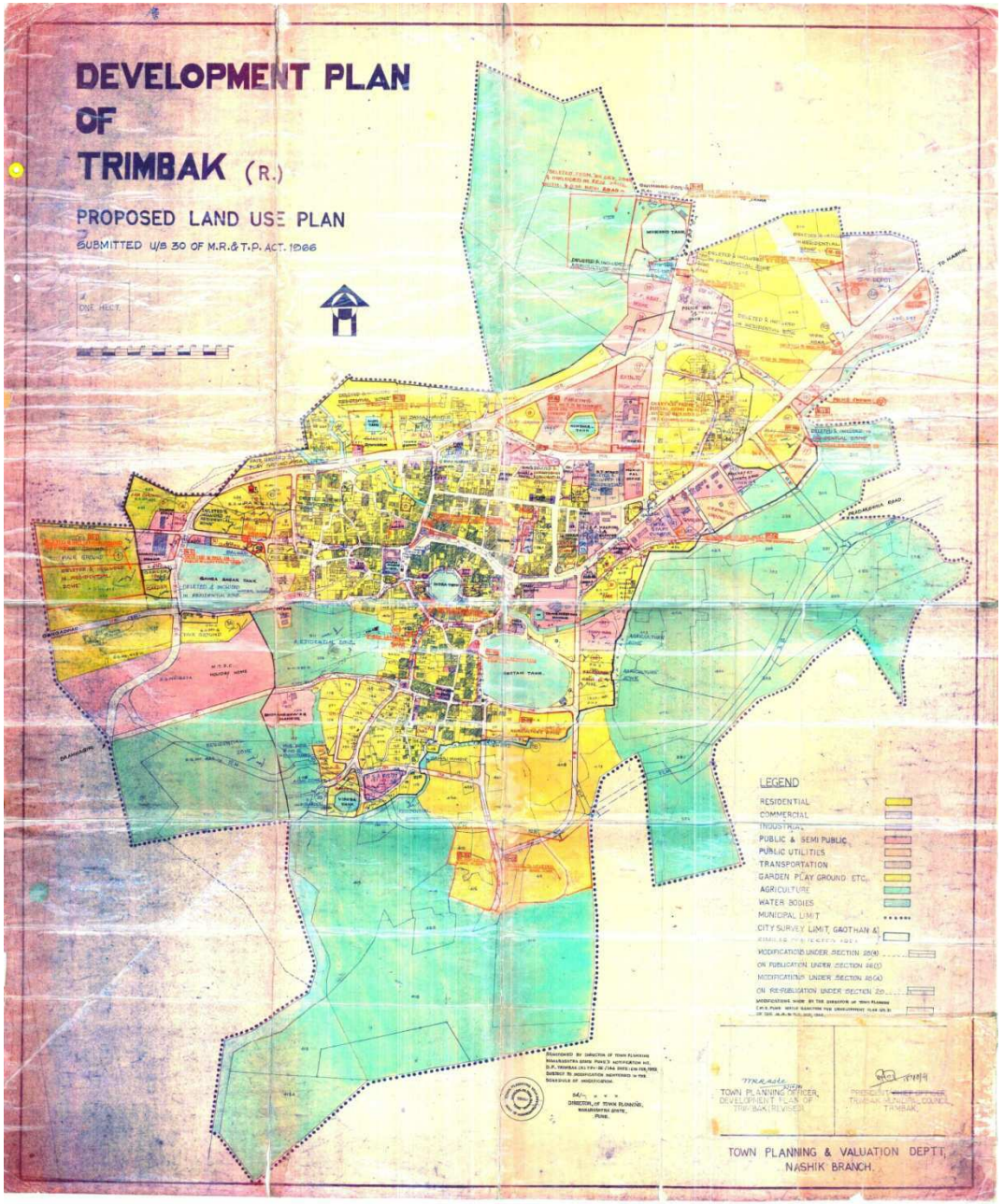
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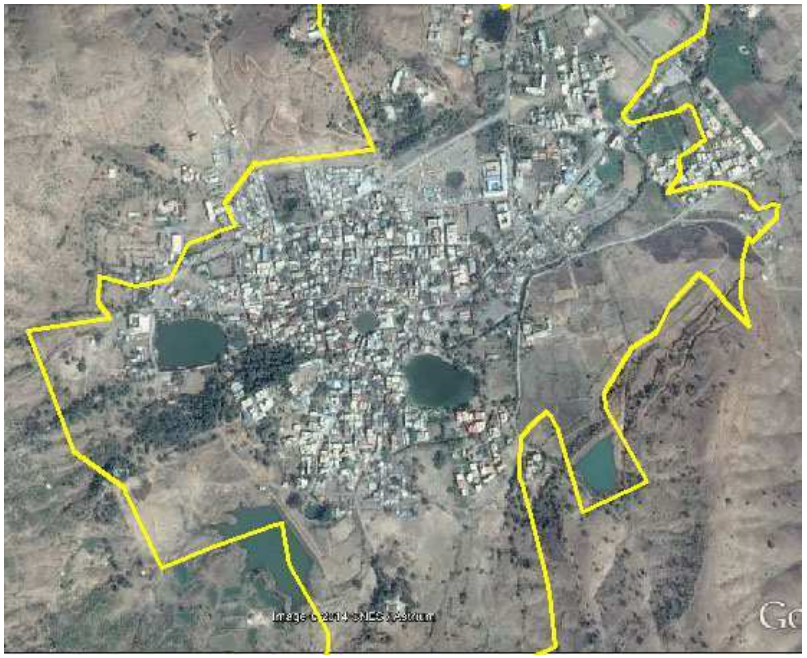
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BACKGROUND AND SCOPE

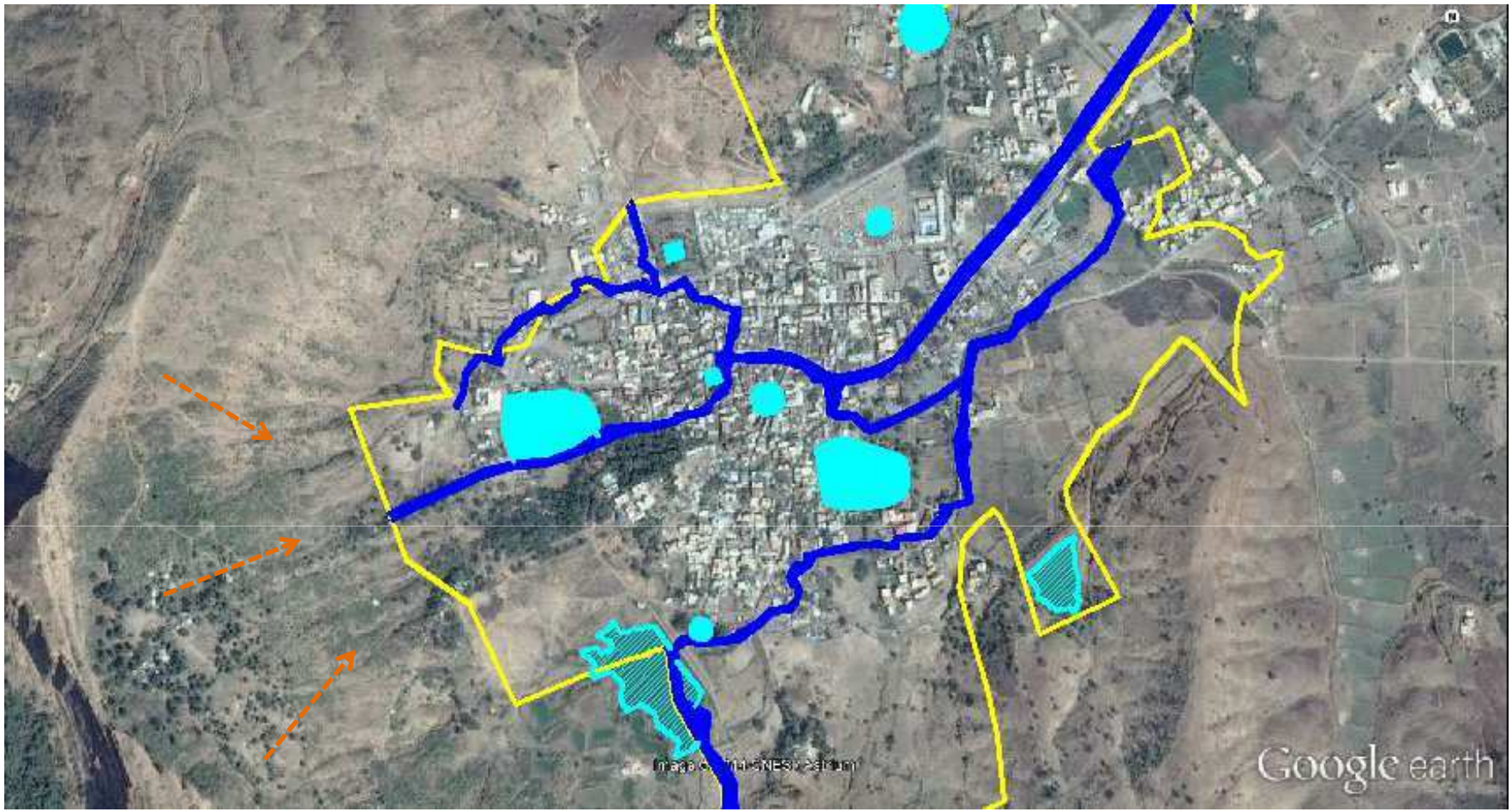




Trimbak, more correctly 'Tryambak' or the three - eyed, a name of Mahadeva, is a small but a far - famed place of Hindu pilgrimage, and origin place of the river Godavari at the base of eastern spur of the Sahyadris, about 29 kms south - west of Nasik. The town municipality has an area of 11.90 Sq. Km., with Hindus are in predominance.

Today, the town is a predominant pilgrimage centre in Maharashtra, and host to the 'Kumba Mela' held here every twelve years.

BACKGROUND AND SCOPE

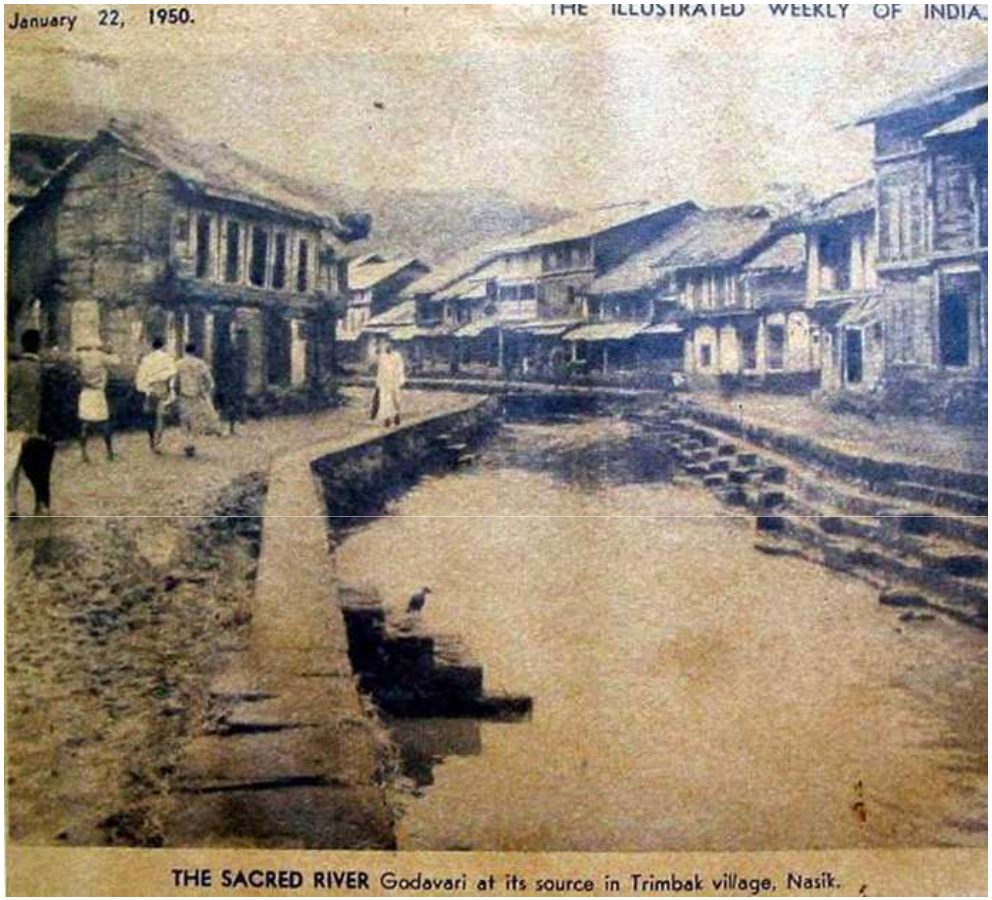


The predominant feature of Tribakeshwar is the network of Ponds and Tanks ('Tirth') throughout the town, along with the source of the sacred River Godavari, fed by mostly underground streams and springs from the neighbouring mountains. This has given rise to an eclectic breed of water – based architecture and intangible rituals, like ritual bathing and performance of last rites, which have become the image of the town today.

Any further planning and development must account for the preservation and sustainable of these water bodies and associated features to properly preserve the town's identity.

WATER BODIES

THE RIVER GODAVARI

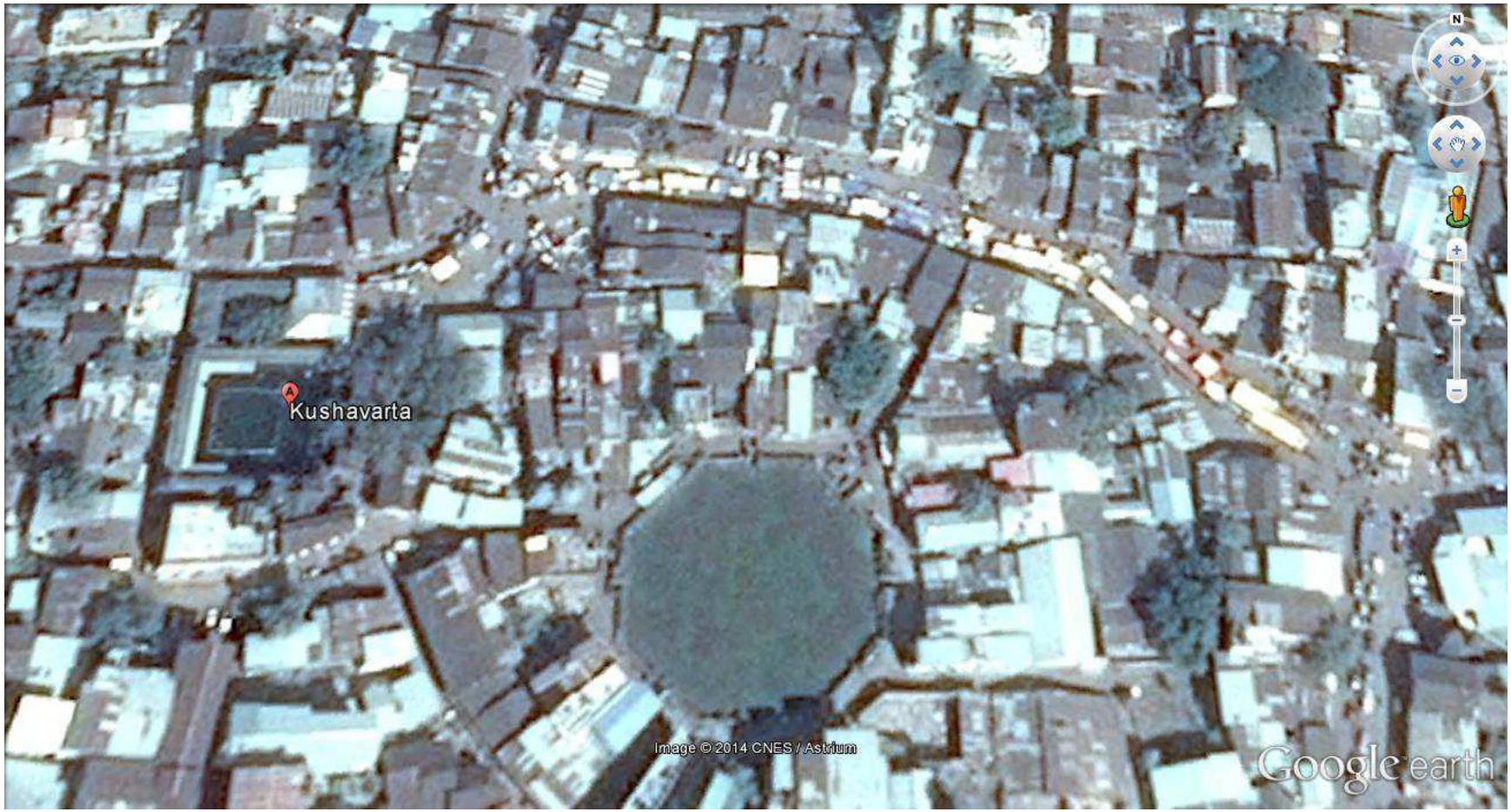


A Photograph from the 1950's, showing the Godavari flowing through the town *in a channel lined with cut-stone masonry, with an short interval steps leading to the water.*

"The Godavari, or the Ganga as it is locally called, is the most celebrated river not only of Nasik district, but of the whole of the peninsular India. The principal course lies just below the scarp of the western side of the Trimbak amphitheatre, where is a temple, reached by a flight of well built steps." – Nashik District Gazetteer

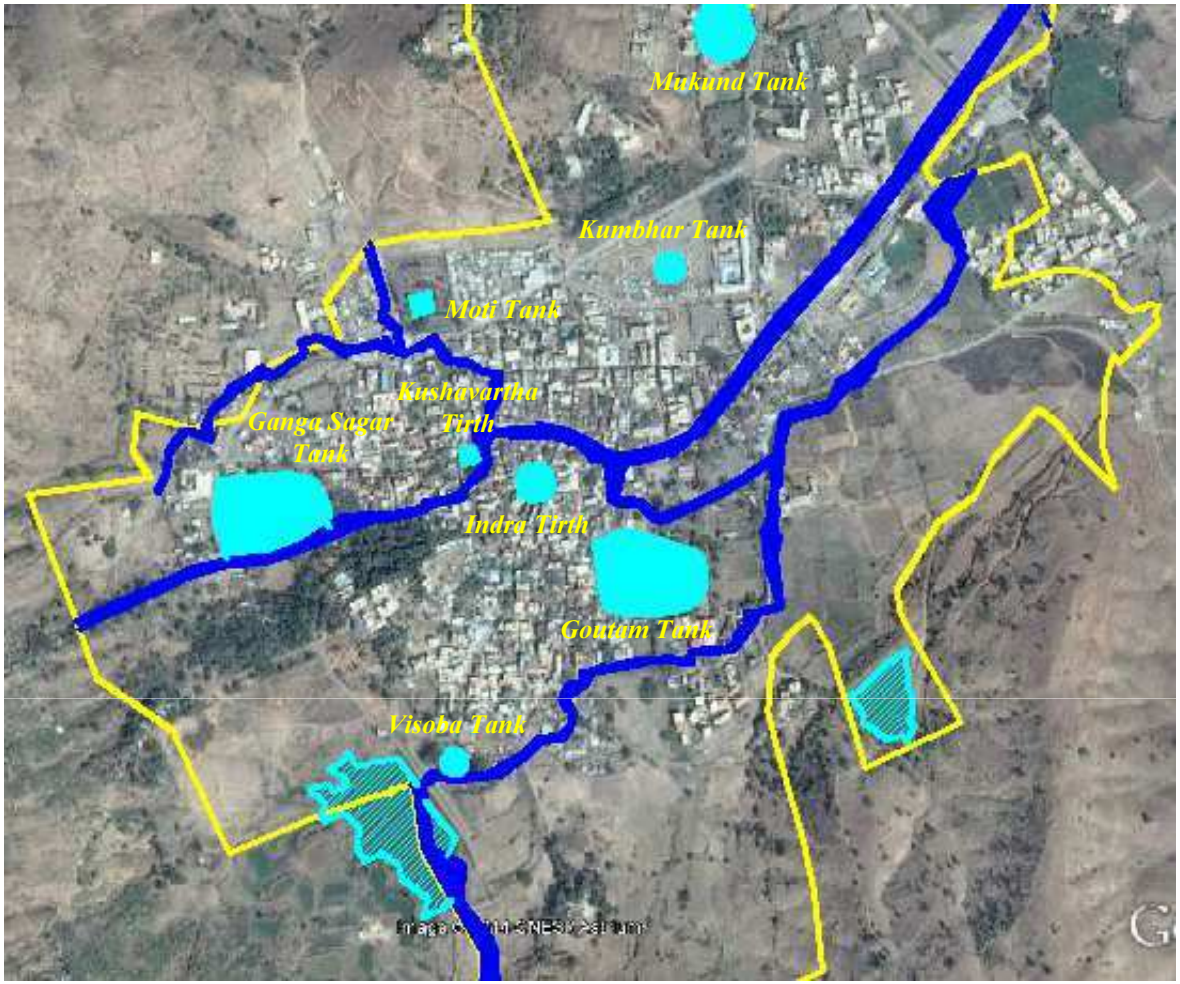


THE EARLIER PASSAGE OF WATER THAT HAS BEEN COVERED WITH AN RCC SLAB OVER WHICH AN INFORMAL VEGETABLE MARKET IS BEING SEEN AS THE MAJOR BONE OF CONTENTION.



WATER BODIES

TALAVS OR PONDS



*There are eight Talavs in and around the town, the most notable of which are the **Visoba Talav** at some distance from the centre of the town on the south, and the **Gangalaya,** also known as **Gangasagar**, on the west. The Gangalaya is a large Talav of 175.26 x 175.26 M. Its sides are said to have been stone lined in about 1777 by Naro Shankar at the cost of Rs. 75,000. The Gangasagar is fed by springs which never shows signs of failing. The overflow of the talav is the source of Trimbak branch of the Godavari, which, though not the highest, is the sacred source. The stream leads to a temple in the town where it feeds a large cut-stone pool, the **Kushavarta Tirth**, considered by the Hindus as the holiest of the holy bathing places in **Trimbak.***

WATER BODIES

KUSHAVARTA TIRTH

Kushavarta is 24.68 x 22.55 m (81'x74') and has three dharmashalas on three of its sides. It is stone lined and has fifteen steps on each of its four sides leading to the water. Platforms have been provided where people can take advantage of the holy bath.

It was built by Ravji Mahadev Parnerkar, the Phadanavis of the Holkar in 1768 at a considerable cost. Every Monday a silver facial plaque of Trimbakeshwar Mahadev is brought here in palanquin procession for bath.



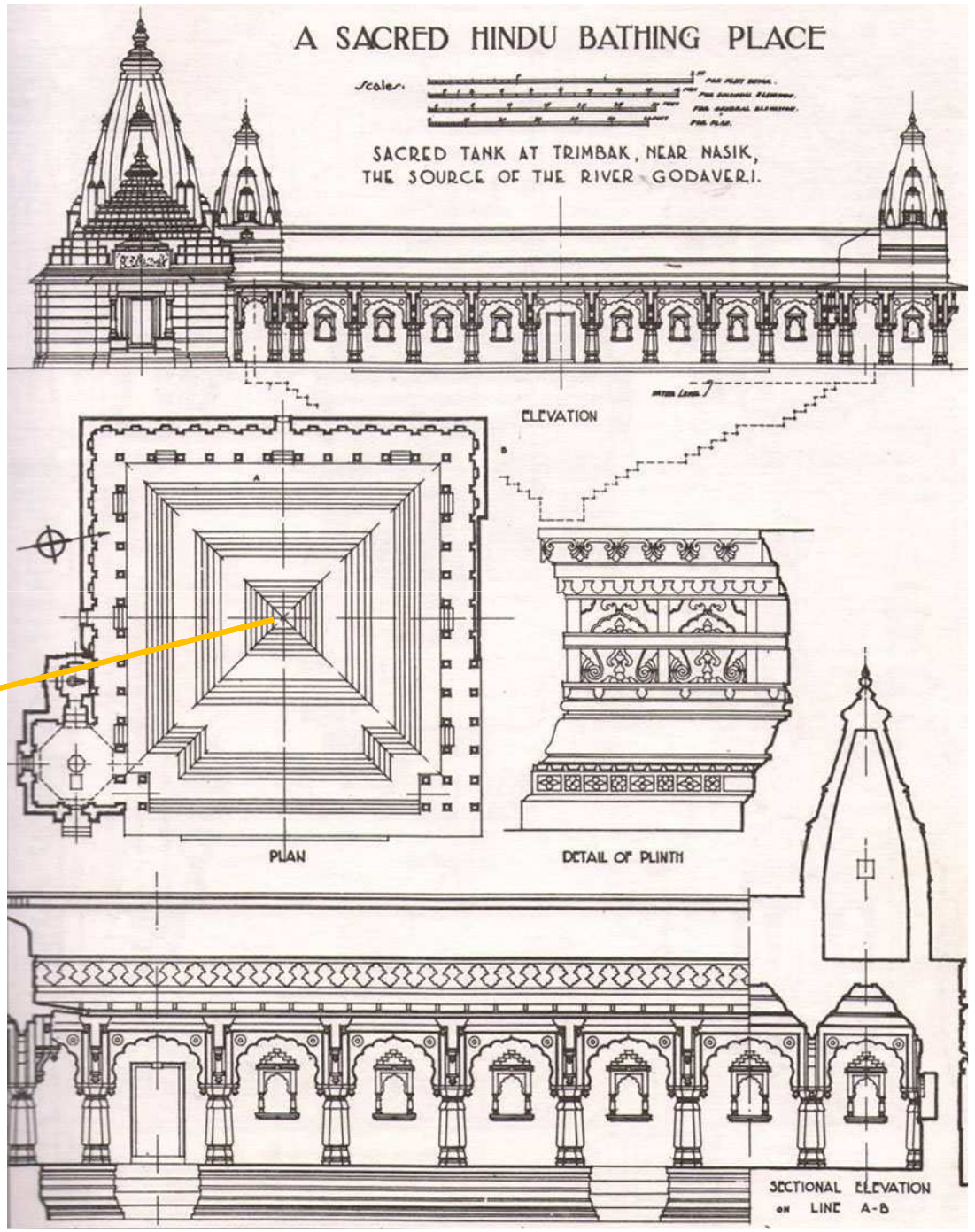
Kushavartha Tirth today with bathing pilgrims



File Picture

Architectural Documentation of Kushvartha Tirth by Claude Batley (first published 1934, 1998 edition Taraporewala Bombay)





WATER BODIES

INDRA TIRTH

Indra Tirth is an octagonal water body at the centre of the town, abutted by a small temple. It enclosed with stone masonry wall and C.I. railing above it.



Neighbouring Temple



Indra Tirth Environs

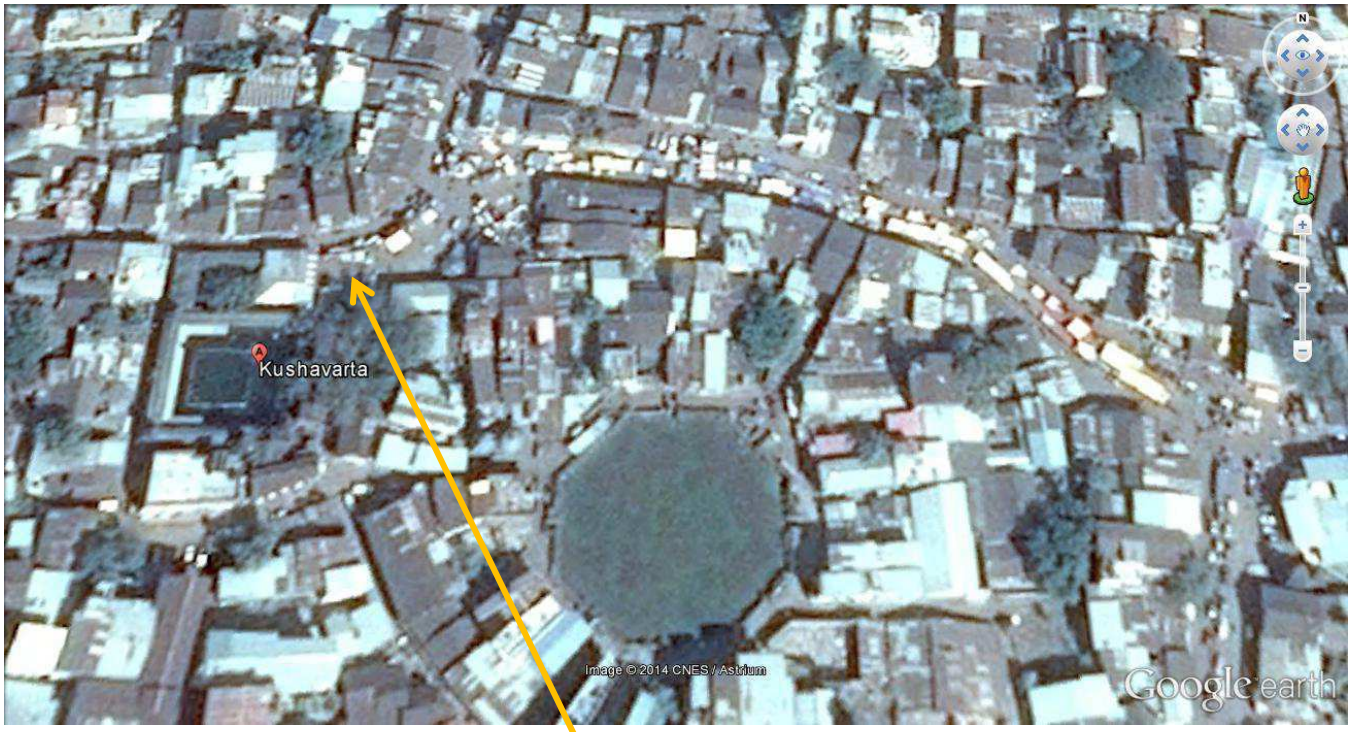


WATER BODIES

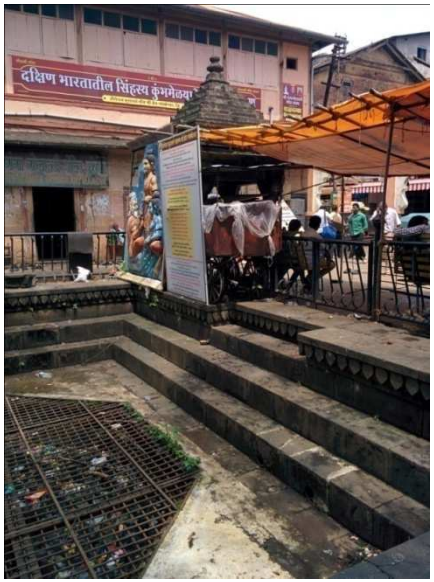
OCTAGONAL KUNDA

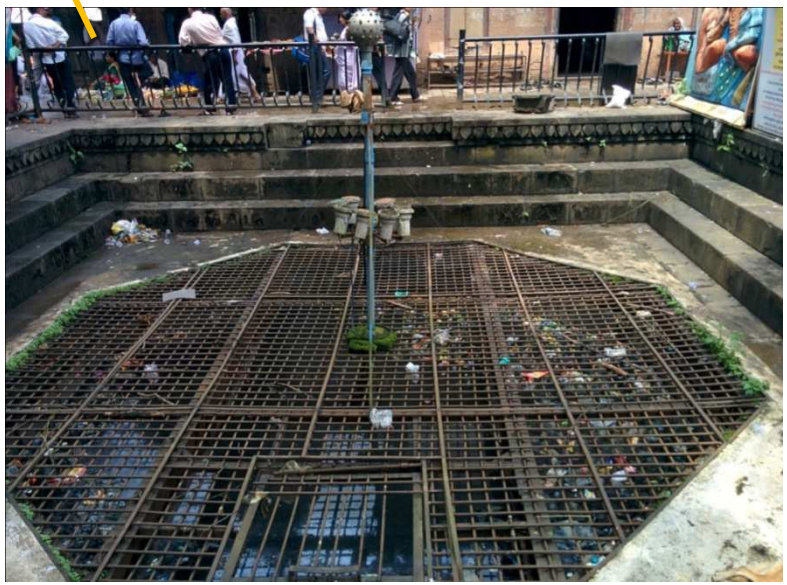
An octagonal water body or Kunda with three steps on each side of the square enclosure leading to the water.

A small temple is attached to the Kunda a temple with a Dharmashala exists on the other side.





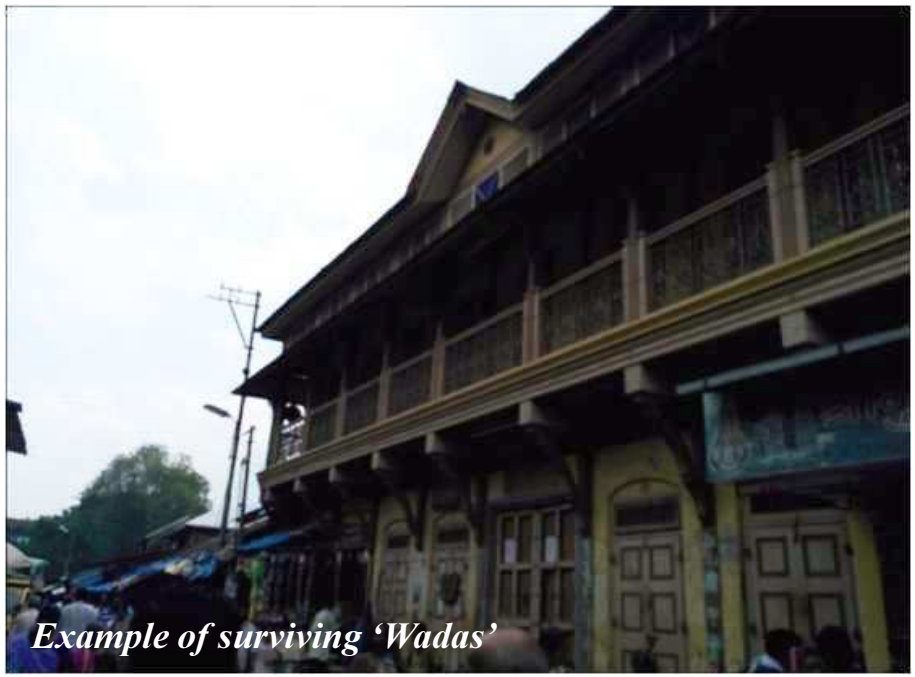




TEMPLES AND WADAS



Trimbakeshwar Temple

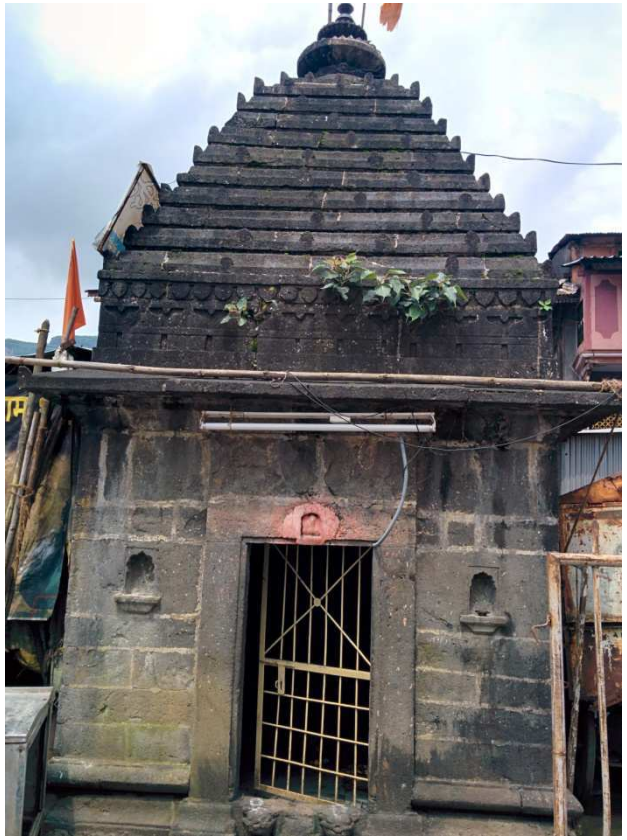


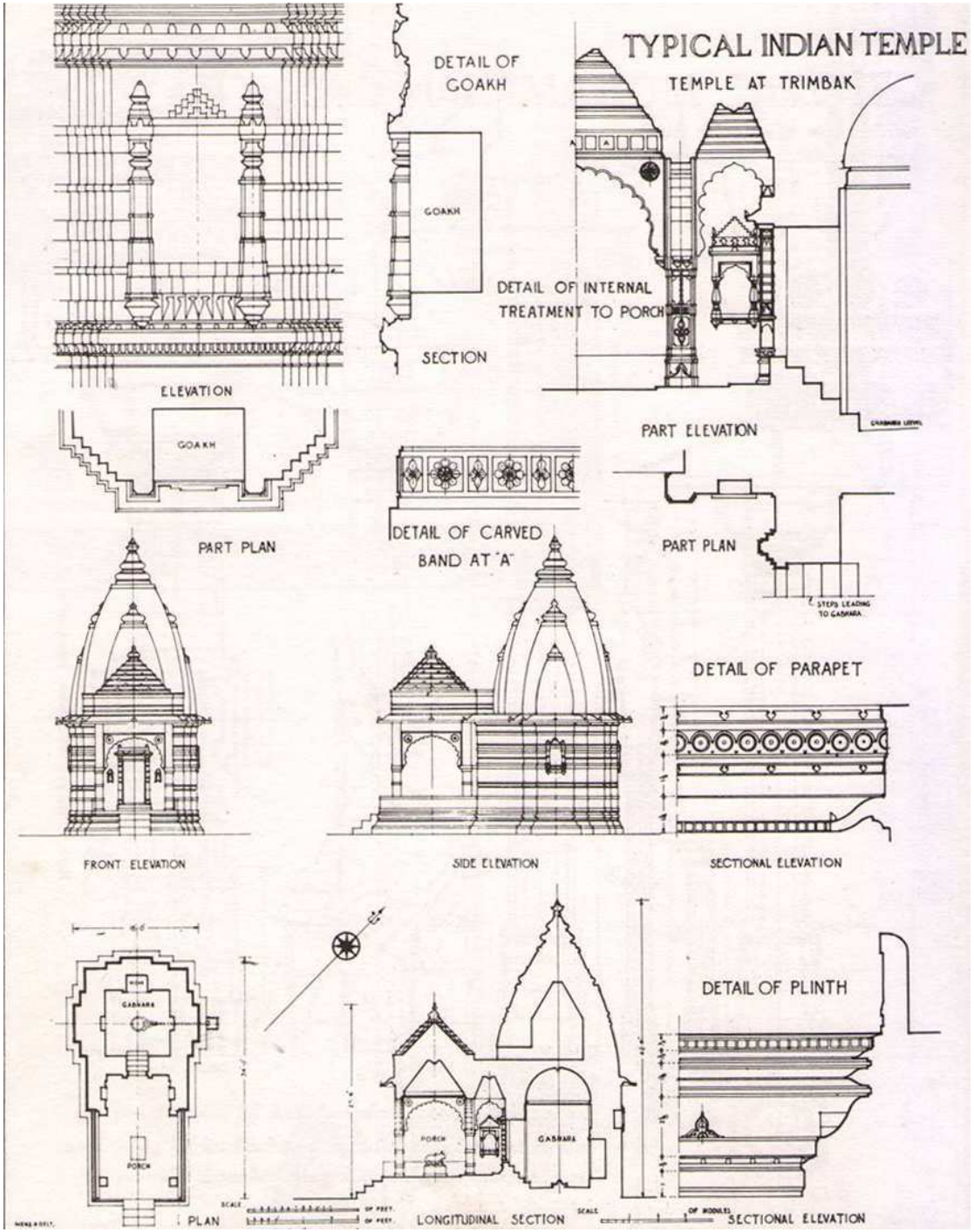
Example of surviving 'Wadas'

The Chief Trimbakeshwar Temple was built by Bajirao I on the site of a much older shrine. It stands in the midst of a paved courtyard enclosed by a huge rampart wall with four entrances. The temple is a broken square in plan and heavily buttressed and ornamented, with cusped arches, branched brackets and ornamental roofs. The complex has a 'Nagarkhana' above the northern entrance, a 'Kothi' or storeroom, ornamental Deepmals, and a 'Nandi' under an elegantly carved stone pavilion.

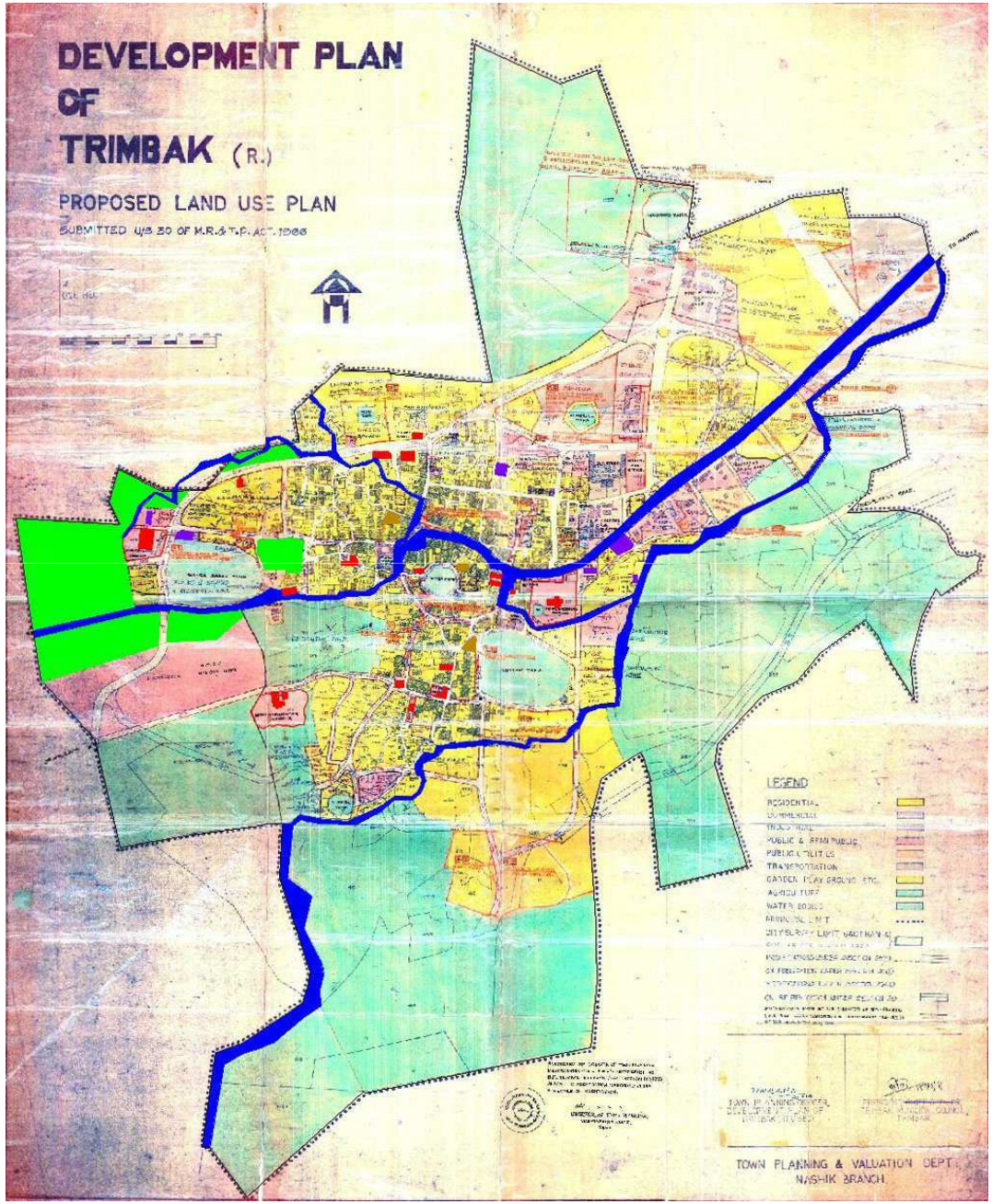
Trimakeshwar is also home to number of large, well – built Wadas with well – raised plinths, deep verandahs and tiled roofs.

Architectural Documentation of Temple at Trimakeshwar by Claude Batley first published 1934, 1998 edition Taraporewala Bombay





MAP SHOWING LOCATION OF HERITAGE STRUCTURES



Mathas or Dharmshalas

Temples

Fair Grounds

Dargahs and other Public Bldgs.

River

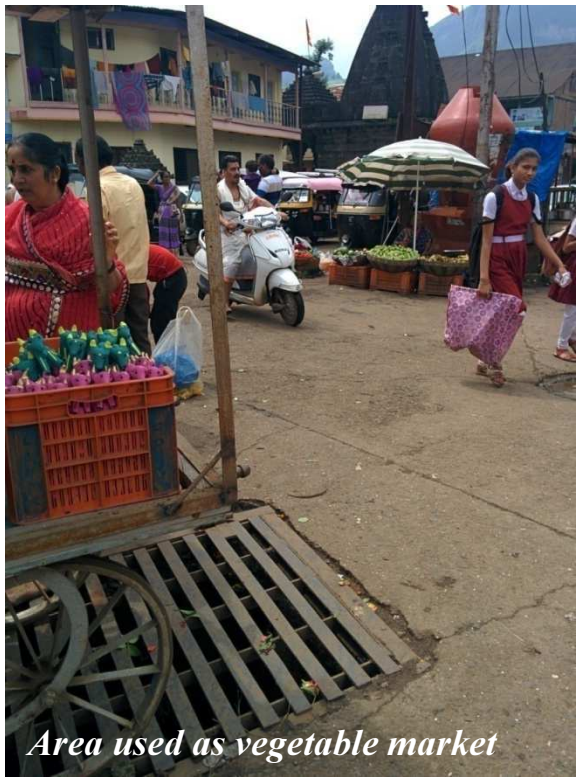


CURRENT CONDITION AND PROPOSALS

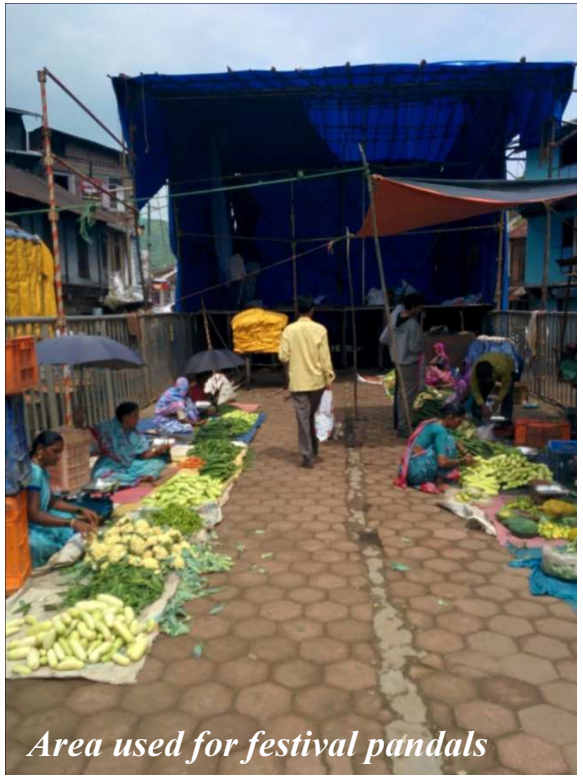
GODAVARI RIVERFRONT



Area used as parking



Area used as vegetable market



Area used for festival pandals

A RCC slab has been constructed above the main stream of the Godavari flowing opposite the Kushavartha and Indra Tirth. Probably built to cover the dry, non – perennial bed of the tributary, this slab is now used as thoroughfare for walking, parking, selling vegetables and temporary pandals for festivals etc.

A major issue is the validity of this slab as it changes an important component of the urban fabric of the town and may pose a hazard to water drainage after flooding.



Area used as thoroughfare

CURRENT CONDITION AND PROPOSALS

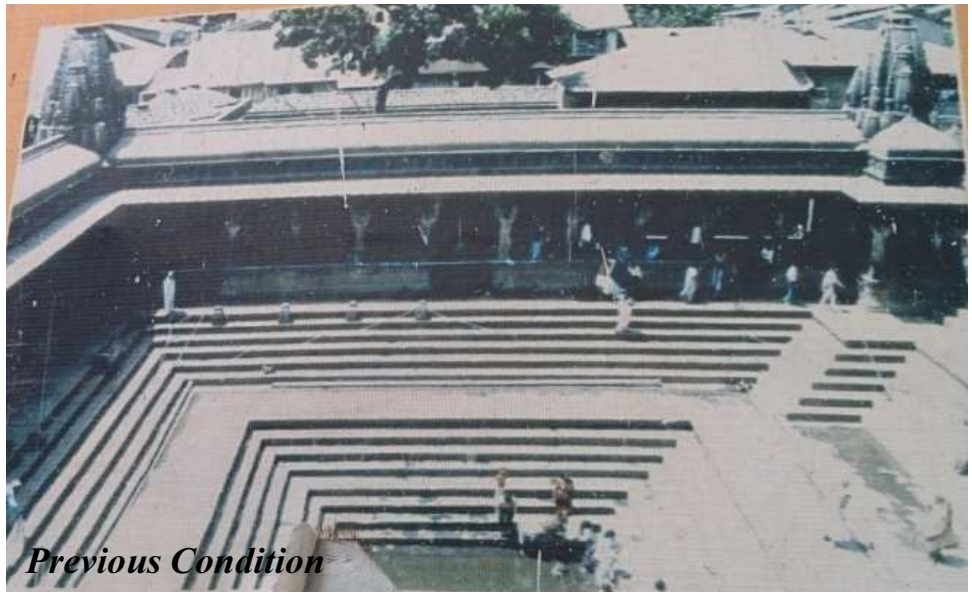
KUSHAVARTHA TIRTHA


Current Condition

Several later additions have been made to the tank's main structure. The tank is currently being augmented by an external water source due to low water levels and an increasing number of visitors. A fountain has been constructed in the tank's centre and a heavy M.S. Railing with signage around its periphery. Roof extensions in G.I. sheets have also been added as extra protection from the sun.

These later additions, though added for public convenience, are incompatible with the heritage nature of the structure.

The true source of the tank needs to be found and an attempt made to recharge it. If not possible, the external pumping can be done in on a stand – alone basis or in a concealed manner. All later additions need to be removed or rebuilt in natural materials like Cast Iron, wood or stone.


Previous Condition

CURRENT CONDITION AND PROPOSALS

KUSHAVARTHA TIRTHA



Temple Structure

The temple and the Deepmal in the Kushavarta Tirtha Premises need specialized restoration. After a through documentation and condition survey of the structures, Special cleaning has to be done to remove the discoloration on the stone due to moss and water seepage. Water proofing and re – pointing in lime has to be done as required, along with selective stone replacement.



Temple Structure



Deepmal

CURRENT CONDITION AND PROPOSALS

KUSHAVARTHA TIRTHA



M.S. Grating attracting waste over secondary tank



Water Purification System in Temple premises

- *The water tank in front of the temple is fed by an external pipeline and covered with a M.S. Grating which has attracted disposed garbage and offerings. Its peripheral walls are also used to dry clothes.*

- *The grating should be removed or reinstalled in a compatible manner. The pipeline should be shifted as an underground installation. Proper signage, separate disposal bins for garbage and offerings and changing and locker rooms are other facilities that need to be provided.*

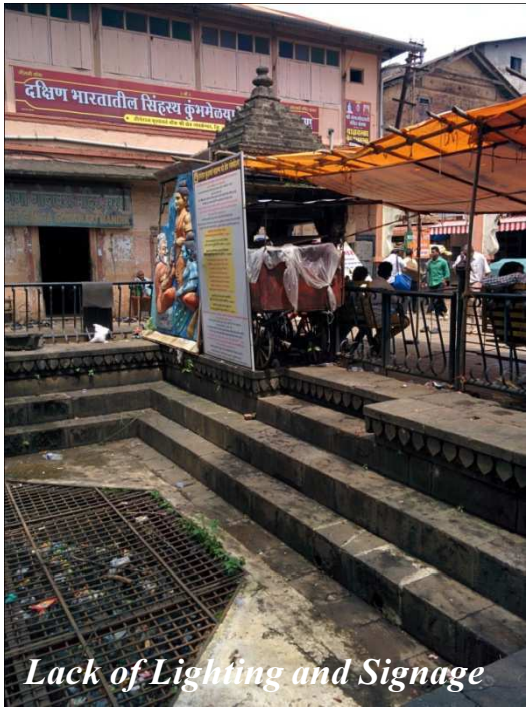
- *Another point of contention is the town's water purification plant which is located in the premises. This large, unsightly structure either needs to be shifted to another location (after consultation with proper authorities) or relocated or covered with a compatible – looking structure.*

CURRENT CONDITION AND PROPOSALS

OTHER WATER BODIES



M.S. Grating and stagnant dirty water



Lack of Lighting and Signage



Incompatible additions



Lack of proper access

Almost all water structures suffer from similar problems of loss of original source leading to pollution of accumulated water, overcrowding and lack of proper facilities in the premises, cleanliness and signage. Incompatible additions are also destroying the inherent beauty of the structures.

All later, unnecessary additions and encroachments should be removed and the premises cleaned. Compatible safety railing, dustbins, lighting and signage need to be designed sensitively and installed.

CURRENT CONDITION AND PROPOSALS

INDRA TIRTHA



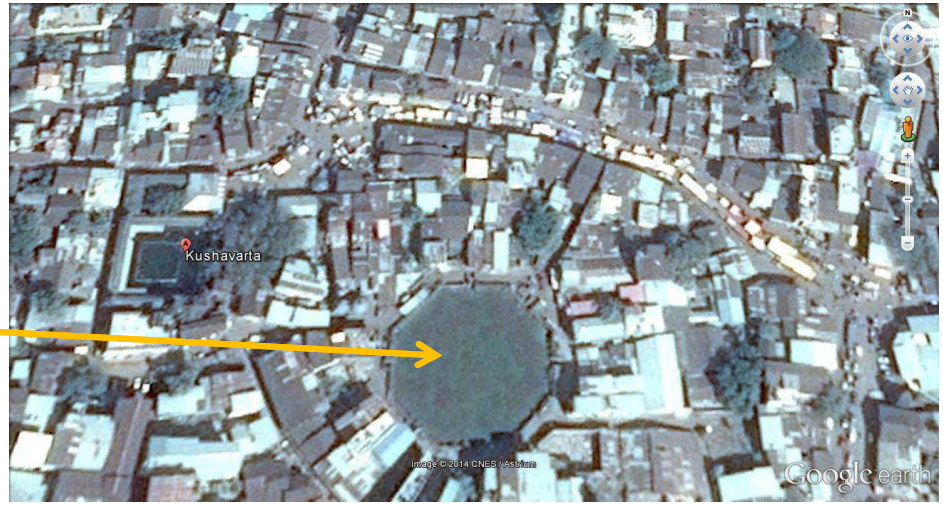
Accumulated Garbage and Vegetation

Indra Tirth, one of the biggest and centrally located tanks in town is in a state of disuse. The tank has probably dried up and is overgrown with vegetation. Vandalism and wear and tear over time can be seen in the form of missing railing and coping masonry in several places. Garbage has accumulated around the periphery, attracting files, insects and animals, thus forming unhygienic conditions for pilgrims and residents alike.

The tank needs major physical restoration and recharge. A proper system for garbage disposal and segregation also needs to be worked out to solve this pertinent, long – term issue.



Broken masonry and C.I. railing



CURRENT CONDITION AND PROPOSALS

TEMPLES AND WADAS

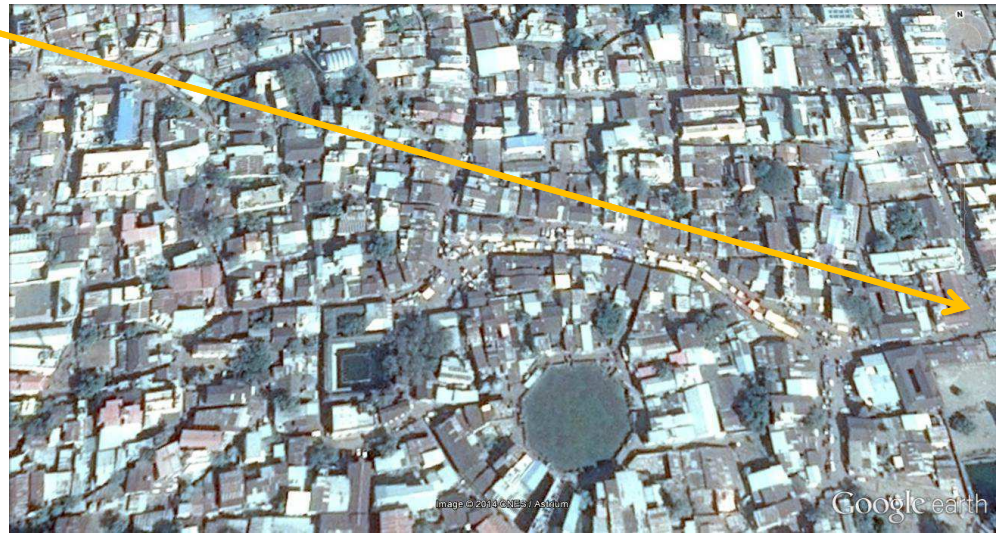


Trimbakeshwar Mandir Entry

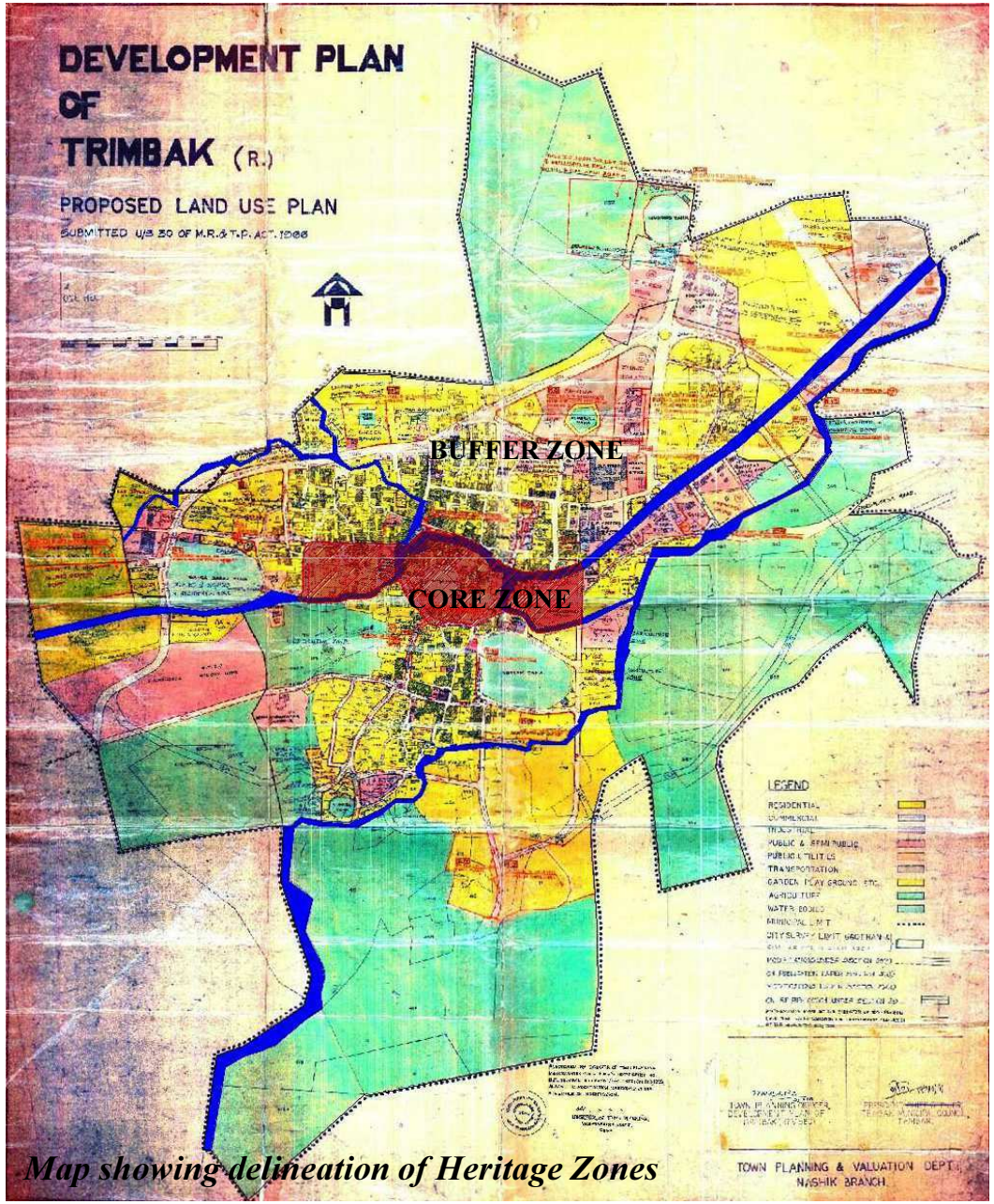

Sangameshwar Mahadev Mandir

The frontages of all major temples and surrounded by shops selling wares and puja items. These destroy the majesty and frontage of these structures as they are organized in a random, haphazard manner.

These shops need to be reorganized or shifted to provide better frontage and street elevation for these structures. The signage and elevations for these shops also needs to be regulated for uniformity.



CONSERVATION OF BUILT HERITAGE



Map showing delineation of Heritage Zones

The townscape of Trimbak can be divided into two zones:

- ***Core Heritage zone,*** *consisting of the Trimbakeshwar temple complex and bound by the Parikrama Patha, along with Kushavarta Tirth, Indra Tirth and Godavari river as a site of natural, religious and cultural significance, with archaeological potential in the future.* ***This delinated zone can be restricted to four wheelers to ease traffic and control destruction of urban fabric due to road widening. A further pedestrian only zone can be created in the central area bound by the Godavari riverfront for its conservation.***

- ***Buffer Heritage zone,*** *comprising the area outside the core zone, within the Survey boundary.*



Core Heritage Zone

Core Heritage zone

A. No development or redevelopment or engineering operation or additions, alterations, repairs, renovation including the painting of buildings, replacement of special features or demolition of the whole or any part thereof or plastering of the said listed / heritage buildings or listed / heritage precincts shall be allowed except with prior written permission of the Commissioner. The Commissioner shall act on the advice of / in consultation with an expert Committee **(Reg. No. 67 2(i), Heritage Regulations for Greater Bombay, 1995) [1].**

B. In relation to religious buildings in the said list, the changes, repairs, additions, alterations and renovations required on religious grounds mentioned in the sacred texts, or as a part of holy practices laid down in religious codes shall be treated as permissible, subject to their being in accordance and consonance with the original structure and architecture, designs, aesthetics and other special features thereof.' **(Reg. No. 67 2(ii), Heritage Regulations for Greater Bombay, 1995) [2].**

C. 'Non – cessed buildings included in the said list shall be repaired by the owners / lessees of the said buildings themselves. If they are cessed buildings, those can be repaired by (Development Authority), co – operative society or occupiers of the building. For monetary help for such repairs a separate fund may be created, kept at the disposal of the Municipal Commissioner. Provision for the fund may be made through District Planning and Development Council Budget.' **(Reg. No. 9, Heritage Regulations for Greater Bombay, 1995).**

Buffer Heritage zone

This area will be subject to building regulations, as specified in ***'Standardized Building Byelaws and Development Control Rules for "C" Class Municipal Councils of Maharashtra'*** **[3]** *except for the said list of buildings, artifacts, structures and precincts of historical, aesthetical, architectural or cultural value.*





1. *Indiscriminate changes to heritage structures can reduce the life span of the structure, as they cause unnecessary loading and clog masonry pores and joints, rendering them incapable of shedding moisture or adjustment to chemical and thermal changes.*

2. *Traditional practices such as 'Jeernodhar' are more suited to the upkeep of religious structures, due to their inherent documentative nature and adherence to local material and traditional methods of construction.*

3. *Building byelaws, such as those pertaining to building use, setbacks, heights and provision of parking and services, shall be adhered to, unless otherwise specified.*

IDENTIFICATION OF BUILT HERITAGE

The built heritage of a historic urban area such as Trimbak consists of the following:

- Structures and precincts of historical and religious importance and pilgrimage such as **Temples, Ponds and Tanks ('Tirth')**;
- Places and elements of ecological importance such as **green belts and riverfronts**;
- Urban elements, structures and precincts of communal and associational value such as **Chowks, Ghats, etc**.
- Residential building clusters and typologies such as **Wadas and Dharmshalas**.

These structures, scattered across the urban fabric, are ***historic landmarks*** and ***physical markers***, responsible for the growth and evolution of the town. They are built in various time periods, materials and architectural styles, with different uses, occupancy patterns and changes made over time. For ***effective continuity of urban development*** and ***retention of urban character***, conservation of these structures of varied historical, cultural and architectural importance is required.

The first step towards this is identification of such structures of heritage value, through a ***Listing and Inventory*** process under the above categories. This process would document the relevant property information (such as ownership, age and land survey details), spaces and architectural features worthy of conservation, current state of the structure and possible threats, in the form of written records, sketches and photo - documentation. This would be followed by a process of ***Grading*** of identified examples according to their historical and architectural merit and associative value, for better management and flexibility of development.



General guidelines for conservation of existing buildings in the Heritage zones

In order to safeguard and enhance the basic architectural character and visual appearance of the townscape of Trimbak, the Municipal Authority should endeavor to



1. Safeguard buildings and structures identified in the Heritage List,

2. Encourage the renovation, retention and reuse of dilapidated or empty buildings that make a contribution to the maintenance of visual unity and basic character, along with re – use of sympathetic, second – hand materials, wherever practical.



3. Safeguard features of interest such as stone plinth, overhangs or projecting cornices, use of wooden elements etc.

Traditional structures in exemplary architecture such as these can be reused , either with an adaptive function, or in part for new structures.





A skyline of G + 1 exists throughout most of the town, broken only by new constructions which do not match datum or detail.



New Structures for public use or appreciation such as the fountain above can be seen throughout the city.

General guidelines for new development in the Heritage zones

1. New development shall maintain the skyline in the precinct (without any high rise development) as may be existing in the surrounding area, so as not to diminish or destroy the value and beauty of the said listed Heritage structures.

2. In the control of new development, special regard must be given to the external appearance, scale and siting of new buildings so as to ensure a continuity of local building vernacular,

3. Careful study and analysis of existing buildings; their form, materials, scale and treatment of openings and detail of fenestrations, must be undertaken, so that new building work can be designed to match and complement its surroundings.



Trimbakeshwar Temple



Kushavarta Tirth

Grading of heritage structures

Grade I

Definition

It comprises of Temples and Water bodies of historic importance, prime landmarks of the city, embodying excellence in architectural style, design, technology and material usage; they may be associated with a great historical event, personality, movement or institution.
They deserve careful preservation.

Examples*

- Trimbakeshwar Mandir
- Kushavarta Tirth
- Indra Tirth
- Godavari river stream



Godavari Stream



Indra Tirth

Scope for changes

- No interventions would be permitted either on the exterior or interior unless it is necessary in the interest of strengthening and prolonging the life of the buildings or precincts or any part or features thereof.
- Absolutely essential and minimal changes would be allowed and they must be in accordance with the original.





Grading of Heritage Structures

Grade II

Definition

It comprises of buildings of regional or local importance, possessing special architectural or aesthetical merit. They are local landmarks, contributing to the image and identity of the city.
They deserve intelligent conservation.

Scope for changes

- Grade II(A): Internal changes and adaptive reuse would be allowed, but external changes would be subject to scrutiny.
- Grade II(B): In addition to above, extension or additional buildings in the same plot or compound could, in certain circumstances be allowed, provided that it is in harmony with, and does not detract from existing heritage structures, especially in terms of height and façade.

Examples*

- Gangadevi Temple
- Goraknath's Cave
- Nilambika Temple
- Nivritinath Mandir
- Parashuram Mandir
- Bhuvaneshwar Mandir
- Trimbak Fort
- Notable surviving Wadas and Dharmshalas



CONSERVATION OF NATURAL HERITAGE





Trimbak and the surrounding region has many sites of ecological importance. They include green belts in the form of the surrounding mountains and the riverfront of the Godavari source and its tributaries. These sites are not only rich in history and religious association and are valuable natural resources for human use. The built water bodies in Trimbak, in the form of built ponds and tanks, and the underground springs that feed them, are the source of water for people of the town. Natural pools of water in the surrounding areas are used by villagers for daily activities. The flora and fauna of the surrounding mountains, along with natural caves of archaeological importance, make them a favored spot for hikers.

Industrialization and increased human inflow is shrinking their area and polluting them. Measures such as improvement of catchment area, volume recharge, control of pollution and desilting, proper treatment of sewage and solid waste, conservation of aquatic ecosystem and riverfront development need to be carried out.

CONSERVATION OF MATERIAL AND INTANGIBLE HERITAGE











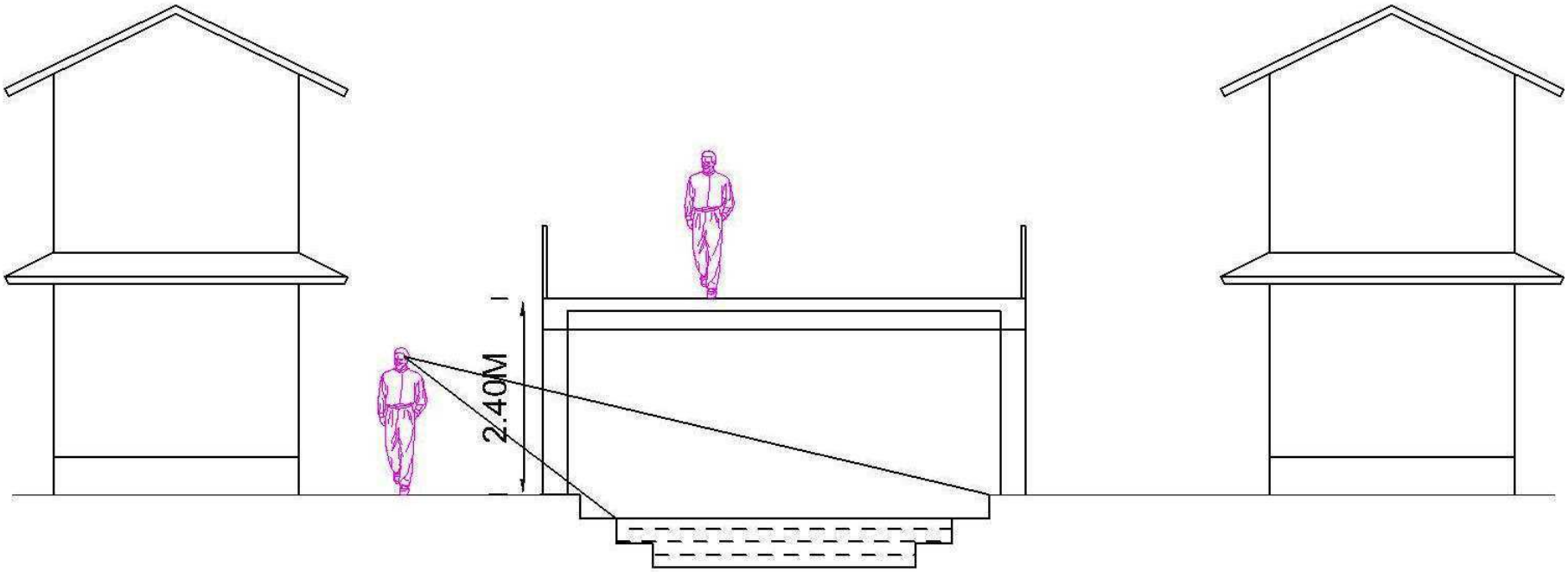
*The **material heritage** of an area consists of the local materials, building crafts and methods of construction indigenous to it which are reflective of the local geography, geology and climate, and historic and cultural influences.* ***The region around Trimbak is rich in material heritage, which especially flourished in the 17th – 19th Centuries, under the patronage of the Peshwas. Materials such as local basalt stone, brick, wood and lime have been artistically used to form architectural elements and artifacts such as Palkhis and statues.***

*The **intangible heritage** of an area consists of the different associations and traditions, which form an important part of its cultural character and traditional significance. It is represented in the form of functional, lifestyle and activity patterns, celebration of festivals and cultural events and rituals associated with rivers and other natural heritage, along with their physical manifestations.* ***Trimbak, as a piligrimage town, not only has ritual bathing and yearly fairs and processions associated with the temple, it is also famous its 'Akadas', and for the rituals for removing 'Nagasarpayog' in birth charts which are only done here in Brahmin residences.***

PROPOSED GOALS AND MEASURES

GODAVARI RIVERFRONT

ALTERNATIVE - 1



The currently constructed R.C.C. slab on the Godavari Riverfront i.e. stretch between Kushavartha Tirth and Trimbakeshwar Mandir has to be removed as it falsifies the actual natural and built fabric in the area and will pose a huge safety risk during flooding. The slab has been built to provide easy access for pilgrims to the surrounding areas, especially during the Kumbh Mela, but is not a viable or sensitive solution considering the above issues.

The slab can be replaced by a skywalk built in stone and cast iron, that will reflect the datum and architecture of the surrounding areas and take care of overcrowding during particular times. This will also mitigate flooding and allow controlled access to the holy river for pilgrims. But the skywalk will destroy the street elevation and privacy of the surrounding houses and lead to neglect of the channel during dry periods.

PROPOSED GOALS AND MEASURES

GODAVARI RIVERFRONT

ALTERNATIVE - 2 *The Godavari Riverfront i.e. stretch between Kushavartha Tirth and Trimbakeshwar Mandir can be transformed into a pedestrianized, open waterfront with Ghats and safety railing at the periphery on both sides. The vehicular access can be rerouted as shown below.*



PROPOSED GOALS AND MEASURES

TOWNSCAPE

Goals and Objectives

- *To provide modern facilities and infrastructure to residents and pilgrims in a sensitive manner.*
- *To provide facilities and infrastructure for the large crowds during the 'Kumb Mela',*
- *To preserve and protect the built, natural and intangible heritage of the area for future generations,*
- *To allow controlled tourism to flourish in the area and provide sustainable livelihood to residents,*
- *To create awareness about the town's vast heritage and culture among tourists and inhabitants.*

Task or Project	*Agency Involved*
Immediate Measures	
To conduct extensive G.I.S. Mapping and environmental studies to find the water sources, and Environmental Impact of dams or bunds built	*Environmental Scientists or Ecology Experts*
To carry out Identification, Listing, Grading and condition survey of existing heritage components in the area.	*Conservation Architect*
Short – Term Measures	
To asses the current infrastructure and plan for future needs	*Infrastructure Consultant*
Formulate projects and required funding based on the above studies	*Infrastructure Consultant, Conservationist*
Attract public participation, source funding and resolve ownership issues	*Local Govt.*
Long - Term Measures	
To design, plan and execute specific projects of restoration and infrastructure development.	*Local Govt., Consultants*

FUNDING MECHANISMS

Provision of Grants for Heritage Conservation

Utilization of the repair fund set aside in the District Planning and Development Council Budgets can be done in the form of Heritage Conservation Grants, given to private and semi – public bodies. These grants are designed to support

- Conservation of buildings of outstanding architectural, historical, and cultural significance.
- Research, documentation in preparation for long term preservation of heritage property or precinct.
- Actual conservation intervention for a highly selective heritage property or precinct.

Types of Grants

Project Identification Grants

Project identification grants are intended to assist in the *initial identification of potential area for conservation*. Grants at this level generally do not exceed *Rs.20 Lakhs*. Eligible activities at the identification level may include, but are not limited to, the following:

- Researching and compiling historic and archival materials;
- Conducting initial photographic, archaeological, structural, and condition surveys;
- Preparing current site and architectural plans;
- Conducting feasibility studies regarding the future use and maintenance of the building;
- Conducting studies of precincts, drafting regulations, guidelines for future development.

Project Preparation Grants

Project preparation is intended to support a *broad range of detailed analytical, investigative, and planning activities synthesized into a comprehensive conservation plan for the building, site or precinct*. Projects at the preparation stage may include a *training component*, i.e. opportunities for students or professionals in architectural conservation to receive training in conjunction with the proposed planning work. Grants at this level may not exceed *Rs.30 Lakhs*.

FUNDING MECHANISMS

Eligible activities at the preparation stage may include, but are not limited to, the following:

- Conducting detailed archival, historical photographic, structural, condition, archaeological, landscape, or other specialized surveys as appropriate;
- Preparing detailed architectural drawings of the current condition of the building;
- Conducting materials testing and analysis to determine appropriate conservation techniques;
- Developing detailed conservation recommendations, technical drawings and specifications, and budget estimates;
- Developing plans for the future use, management, and maintenance of the building;
- Compiling and synthesizing the information gathered through the activities described above into a comprehensive planning document, such as a conservation master plan, historic Structure Report, or detailed conservation plan;
- Publication of Reports, Maps, Books;
- Undertaking temporary emergency conservation measures to stabilize a structure prior to actual intervention work as part of a broader planning project, which includes activities such as those outlined above.

Project Implementation Grants

Project implementation grants are intended for following:

- Assist in the actual stabilization and conservation of a building's historic structure and fabric
- On – site training of students or professionals (6 months), in conjunction with the proposed conservation work. Grants at this level generally do not exceed Rs. 50 Lakhs.

Possible sources of funding for sustenance of conserved properties

Heritage properties which have been conserved using the above grants need to generate funds, not only for future maintenance and upkeep but also full or partial recovery of state or private investment. This can be done through:

- Increase in rent or levy of entry fees;
- Regular donations through religious trusts or charitable organizations;
- Use of camp sites, riverfronts, public plazas and other serviced, open spaces for organization of 'Jathras', fairs, music and dance performances and other cultural events;
- Organization of yearly festivals which allow outsiders to explore local culture and architecture through photo and artifact exhibitions, food festivals and heritage walks.

FUNDING MECHANISMS

Grant Eligibility

Organizations or Individuals are eligible to apply for architectural conservation, planning and implementation grants. Funds are intended to *engage the services of conservation professionals to develop and manage multidisciplinary, comprehensive conservation projects and assist in the conservation of a single building or a group of related buildings precincts.*

The building (or each of the buildings, if more than one) must meet the following requirements:

- Buildings owned by a nonprofit, charitable organization (or its equivalent), which are committed to the long term preservation and maintenance, shall be preferred first;
- Conservation project for the building must be approved by the building Owner or Trust or Society;
- The building must be accessible to the public or used for the benefit of the community;
- The building must be a listed building in accordance with the list of heritage buildings published by Government or if any unlisted building, it should fall within a precinct.

Non Eligibility

Projects focused primarily on *architectural replacement, interior restoration, rehabilitation, commercial adaptive reuse, building maintenance* are not eligible. In addition, funding will not available for work that has already been completed or for overhead costs of an organization.

FUNDING MECHANISMS

Preliminary Application

Potential applicants are asked to submit a *preliminary letter* before submitting a formal application. This letter is used to determine the project's eligibility. If the project is eligible, application forms and instructions will be sent to the applicant or organization.

Review Process

Applications will be reviewed primarily on the basis of

- Architectural, cultural, and historical significance of the building(s);
- Feasibility of work plan;
- Suitability of proposed conservation methods;
- Qualifications of project personnel;
- Environmental impact;
- Project budget;
- Assurance of project 's successful completion;
- Importance of project to the community;
- Future use and maintenance program;
- Potential of project to serve as a model;
- Training opportunities provided by the project.

The application will be reviewed by a group of experts nominated by the administration and consisting of historians, conservation architects, material and structural experts, environmentalists etc. The comments and recommendations of this group will provide the basis for the Grant Program's final decision.

FUNDING MECHANISMS

Project Funding

Grants at the project implementation level for some of the proposals usually require matching funds; that is, additional funds equal to the amount of the grant must be contributed to the project by the applicant or by an outside source. Grants at the project implementation level require at least this type of one – to - one match, and in some cases a two-to-one match is necessary.

Grantees are required to submit six monthly progress reports which will be appraised by Sub-committee (if required, site visits will be conducted) and a final report, including technical and photographic documentation, following the project's conclusion.

The Grant Program cannot provide funding for work that has already been completed. In order to accommodate the review process that precedes notification of any grant award, the work for which funding is currently being requested should be scheduled to commence no sooner than the Project is cleared.

Project Proposal

Inquiries for assistance should be in the form of a brief preliminary letter (no more than three pages). The Project Proposal must be submitted by an individual organization. It should include the following:

- A description of the proposed project, including information about the planning or implementation activities for which funding is requested and a corresponding budget;
- Type of grant requested;
- An estimate of tile amount of funding to be requested;
- A brief description of any preliminary research, conservation planning, documentation, or actual intervention work completed to date;
- Photographs highlighting the building's significance and current condition are also helpful.

Submission Period

If a project described is eligible for grant consideration, the Organization or Individual will be invited to formally explain the project proposal. Although the preliminary letter may be submitted at any time, applications are considered only three times a year. Deadlines for the receipt of completed applications will be accepted twice a year. (1st January, and 1st July).

NEWS

HC asks MPCB, NMC to check pollution in Godavari river
Last Updated: Wednesday, February 27, 2013 - 10:57

Mumbai: The Bombay High Court has asked Maharashtra Pollution Control Board and Nashik Municipal Corporation (NMC) to urgently check pollution in Godavari river which originates at Trimbakeshwar, near Nashik, a major pilgrim centre.
Perusing the affidavit filed by NMC on February 24, a bench headed by Justice Abhay Oka observed that it was general in nature and that they were not satisfied with the steps taken to check pollution.
The judges asked the NMC to file further affidavit within three weeks on concrete steps it proposed to take to clean Godavari river and prevent pollution.
The court was hearing a PIL filed by Rajesh Pandit, a social worker, who contended that garbage and untreated effluents are released into the river thereby causing pollution.
Besides, many pilgrims visit Nashik and Trimbakeshwar which houses one of the 12 `Jyotirlingas` (temples) of Lord Shiva.
People even visit Nashik to perform the last rites of their ancestors and in the process they drop `pooja` articles such as flowers etc. In Godavari river thereby causing pollution, the PIL alleged.
The civic body should stop devotees from immersing pooja articles in the river by deploying guards on the banks at Nashik and Trimbakeshwar, the PIL said.
Instead, the PIL suggested, special pots should be put up on the banks of the river and devotees should be persuaded to deposit pooja articles in these pots.
The PIL suggested that the NMC should put up boards on the banks of the river, displaying warnings that the water is not suitable for drinking and the river would get polluted if articles are dumped into it, thereby preventing devotees from indulging in this practice.
Posting the matter for hearing after three weeks, the court asked the MPCB and NMC to monitor pollution level in Godavari and take urgent steps to check it.
PTI

NEWS

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NEWS

Govt agencies await funds from Centre for Kumbh

Sumita Sarkar, TNN | Oct 5, 2014, 08.40AM IST

NASHIK : With various government agencies still awaiting central funds to be utilised to tackle issues such as the pollution of the Godavari and create infrastructure as part of next year's Kumbh Mela, Shiv Sena MP from the city on Saturday said he would take up the issue with Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

The Nashik Municipal Corporation (NMC) is supposed to get Rs 1052.61 crore sanctioned as part of the Kumbh Mela projects, of which the state government has to give Rs 350 crore. The Centre has denied to provide the funds and asked the civic body to generate the rest of the amounts. Until now, the state government has released Rs 220 crore to the NMC out of the Rs 350 crore. Only six months are left to wrap up all major projects for the religious event.

Godse, who had led a delegation to the Centre to seek Kumbh funds, had recently raised the issue with Union finance minister Arun Jaitley. But nothing seemed to materialise and Godse said he would now talk to Modi who would visit the city on Sunday.

"The Centre has declined to release funds for Kumbh Mela. I met Jaitley and told him that Kumbh Mela is a national event, which is held at only four cities in the country. The Centre gave us funds during the last Kumbh 12 years ago and it also gave amounts to Allahabad last year for Kumbh Mela. On September 16, Jaitley had assured that he would include it in the supplementary budget in November. I met him again recently. He said the government was in the process of formulating the guidelines for religious activities. I told him that the Kumbh Mela is going to be held nine months from now and all the works have to be completed before that. The guidelines for such events would take at least 3-4 months. I requested him to look into it. I have also written to him. I will meet Modi on Sunday and talk to him about it," Godse said.

He added that he would also be talking to Modi about the Godavari Riverfront development on the lines of Sabarmati Riverfront.

Environment activists, on the other hand, are seeing red in the face as cleaning the river is part of the Kumbh projects and the Centre has not released any funds for it.

NEWS

Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced in New York recently about his priority to clean River Ganga, but the Godavari, along which Kumbh Mela is scheduled in 2015, continues to flow murky.

"He has been speaking about cleaning River Ganga. But what about Godavari? How can you have Kumbh Mela Unless the river is healthy how can the Kumbh Mela be held? These funds will also have to be utilised for constructing sewage treatment plants or modifying the present STPs so that dirty water is not released into it," said Rajesh Pandit, an environmental activist and one of the petitioners of the public interest litigation (PIL) filed against government officials for river pollution.

"This Godavari has been declared a dead river by the high court after it heard all the arguments and saw the facts produced and also the reports by NEERI. The court also asked the NMC to put up warning boards on the river banks reading that the river was unfit for human consumption and use," said Pandit.

Magsaysay awardee water activist Rajendra Singh, who has been to the city number of times and has joined in the movement of the green activists, had written to the state government not to conduct the Kumbh Mela until the river is cleaned. "Kumbh Mela should not be held unless the river is cleaned and made healthy once again. It will be dangerous for the pilgrims' health," said Singh.

NEWS

Panel releases action plan for green Kumbh

Sumita Sarkar, TNN | Sep 7, 2014, 10.43AM IST

inShare

NASHIK: The action plan for a green Kumbh Mela that focuses on eliminating use of plastic, treating nirmalya and other bio-degradable waste, banning washing in the Godavari and an aggressive awareness drive was officially released on Saturday.

The city mayor and the revenue commissioner released the plan at a function at the Mahatma Phule Kaladalan, where the office of the Green Kumbh was also inaugurated on Saturday. They also released the logo of Green Kumbh.

As per the Bombay high court order in response to the public interest litigation (PIL) filed by Godavari Gatarikaran Virodhi Manch against government officials for river pollution, an expert committee was formed. This committee headed by the revenue commissioner and comprising various government officials and members of the NGO will be spearheading the campaign for Green Kumbh.

With the official release of the action plan, the projects for the Green Kumbh are expected to be streamlined. The awareness campaign committee has already begun conducting various programmes in schools and colleges.

Revenue commissioner Eknath Davle explained the concept of gree Kumbh and the activities to be undertaken. "The activities will involve eliminating plastic, treating nirmalya and other bio-degradable waste, creating awareness about idol immersion, banning washing of clothes, animals and vehicles in the river and educating about cleanliness," he said.

He said the solid waste should be sorted and collected at the source of collection. Activities and projects under Green Kumbh are being carried out from August 15 and would continue till August 15, 2016. Swami Samvidanand Saraswati, who was present during the programme, said "We have to take care of nature." Swami Bhaktisharandas, district collector Vilas Patil, Kumbh Mela officer Mahesh Patil, actor Chinmay Udgirkar and others were present for the programme.

"In a short notice, the action plan and the office has been released. A centralised office was necessary to carry out Green Kumbh and that has been made available for us. We all have to work together for the Green Kumbh to take place," said Rajesh Pandit of the NGO.